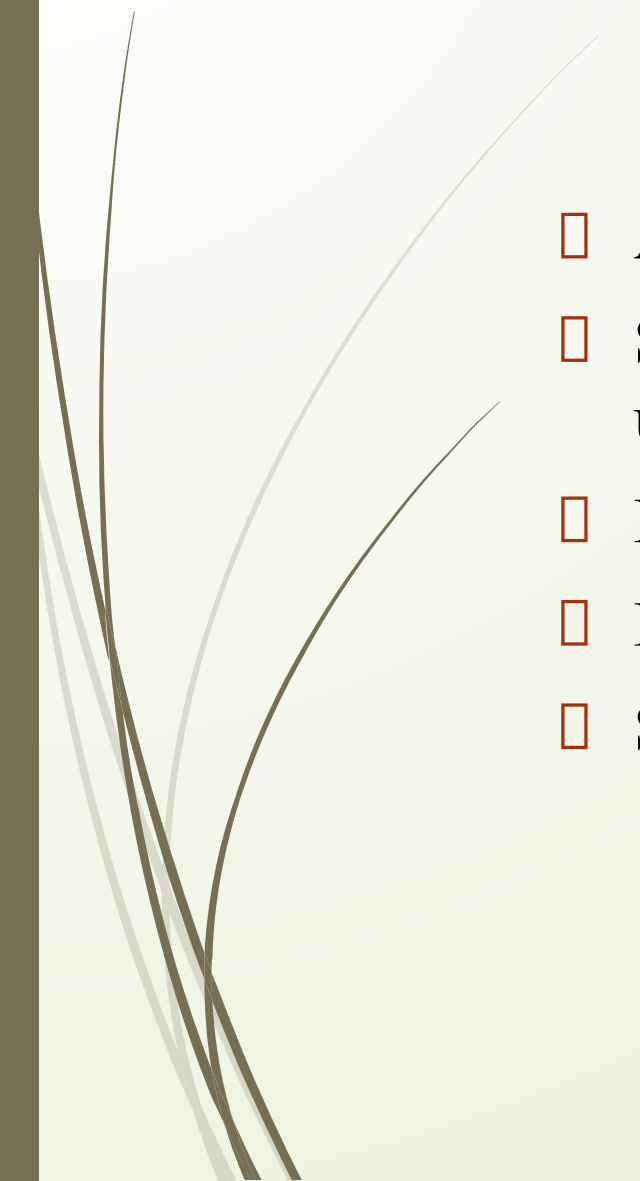




Introductory Paragraph

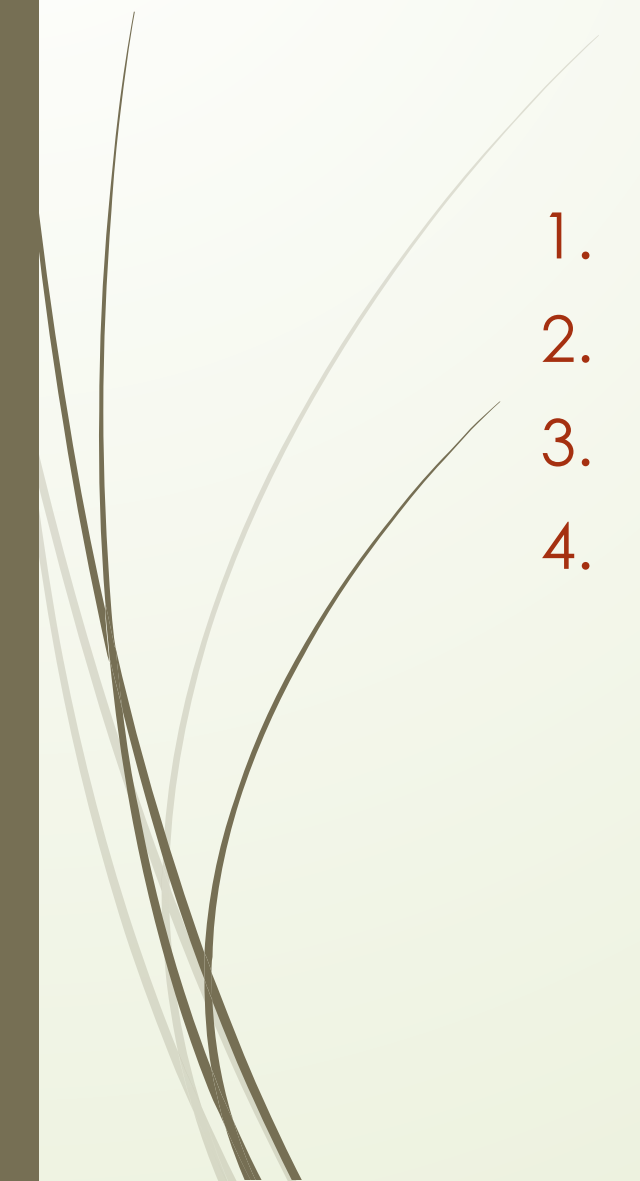


Functions of the Introduction

- 
- ❑ Attracts the reader's interest
 - ❑ Supplies the background information that a reader may need to understand the topic
 - ❑ Provides a thesis statement
 - ❑ Presents the plan of development
 - ❑ Set tone for the rest of the essay



Parts of Introductory Paragraph

- 
1. Motivator / Attention Grabber
 2. Thesis Statement
 3. Overview of Main Body Points
 4. Conclusion (optional)



Motivator

- It is called “Hook” or “Attention-Grabber”
- It hooks the attention of the reader
- It must lead to thesis statement
- There are many kinds of motivators:
 - General to specific Idea
 - Use a quotation or saying
 - Ask a thought provoking question
 - Begin with a surprising fact or idea
 - Use an incident or brief story



General to Specific Idea

Broad and general statements give the readers background information about the topic and then the topic is further narrowed to thesis statement.

Example:

Bookstore shelves today are crammed with dozens of different diet books. The American public seems willing to try any sort of diet, especially the ones that promise instant, miraculous results. Authors are more than willing to invent new fad diets to cash in on this craze. Unfortunately, some of these fad diets are ineffective or even unsafe. One of the worst fad diets is the Palm Beach diet. It is impractical, doesn't achieve results, and is a sure route to poor nutrition.



Personal Example

- On Friday, February 19, 2011, life changed for an eighteen-year-old young man. He became very ill from a bacterial infection. His body could not fight the infection. Why? After a week of tests and examinations by several specialists, the diagnosis was made. He had leukemia, a cancer of the bone marrow. I am that young man. When a person finds out that he has cancer, just as I did, his whole world changes. *A cancer patient is affected physically, psychologically, and socially by the impact of cancer.*

Use a Quotation or Saying

Using a quotation in introductory paragraph catches readers' attention and shows that you have explored what others have to say about the subject.

Content of quote should be: **dramatic, emotionally appealing, surprising, or humorous**

Example:

“The mind is its own place, and in itself can make a heaven of hell, a hell of heaven” (255). This thought by John Milton was recorded over four hundred years ago, but it is still timely for us today. He seems to be saying that we are the ones to control our lives. We can be miserable when things are going well, just as we can be happy when things are going wrong. *With this thought in mind, we can control the way we face life through our attitude, our determination, and our ability.*



Ask a Thought Provoking Question

Questions grasp reader's curiosity instantly without any effort.

Example:

What does make a leader truly great? Some inspire through words, others through actions, but few have impacted history as profoundly as Nelson Mandela. His unwavering commitment to justice and equality, even in the face of great adversity, sets him apart as a remarkable figure. Mandela's resilience, dedication to ending apartheid, and efforts toward reconciliation shaped not only South Africa but the world, leaving an enduring legacy of peace and hope.

Begin with a surprising Fact or Idea

A surprising fact or idea arouses the reader's curiosity about how you will support this initial startling statement.

Example:

According to an article in *Family Safety & First Aid*, published by Berkley Books, "... every 45 seconds a fire breaks out in an American home – 700,000 residences aflame each year. And 16 times a day somebody dies in one of these burning homes" (45). These statistics are frightening and should not be taken lightly. The best way to deal with the possibility of loss from fire is to plan ahead before it happens; otherwise, it is too late. In order not to become one of these statistics, *Americans need to equip their homes with safety devices, set and adhere to safety rules, and practice a family escape plan in order to protect their families.*

Use an Incident or Brief Story

Stories are naturally interesting. They appeal to a reader's curiosity. The story should be brief and should be related to your main idea.

Example:

This morning's news reported that a young girl, age 5, was abducted from her classroom. As a frantic search ensued, people across the Philadelphia area were shocked to find that the kidnapper walked right into the child's classroom and demanded that the young kindergartner leave with the woman. The child managed to escape and was found, but she had been attacked by her captors. Obviously, safety procedures broke down and this poor child paid the price. Schools must urgently reevaluate their safety protocols to ensure that no child is put at risk due to preventable lapses in security. *In order to assure the safety of all children, schools across the country must review safety procedures, tighten safety protocols where necessary, and assure all staff members are properly trained.*



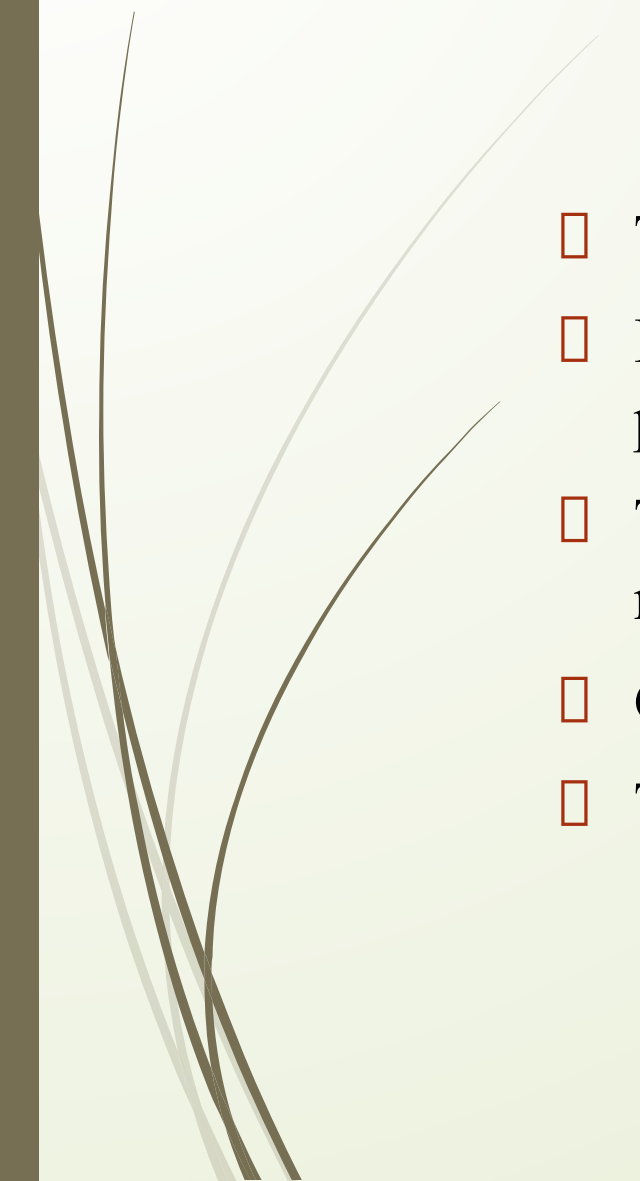
Thesis Statement



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DFp1uGTxo4Q>



Thesis Statement

- ❑ Thesis statement is the main point or central idea of the essay
 - ❑ It tells reader that what is the topic of the essay and what is the main point
 - ❑ The topic of the thesis statement should not be too broad or too narrow
 - ❑ General topic should be narrowed down
 - ❑ Thesis statement must make a point about a limited subject
- 



Subject + Opinion + Main Points = Thesis Statement

- Subject: The topic or material you are writing about
- Opinion: The attitude, position, or feeling you have regarding your topic (subject)
- Main Points: Facts and reasons used to support your *opinion* about your *subject*



Baseball Cards



Subject

- Collecting Baseball cards

Opinion

- Is a good investment

Main Points

- Relatively inexpensive when new
- Become valuable
- Retain value



Thesis Statement



Collecting baseball cards is a good investment because baseball cards are relatively inexpensive when new, become valuable quickly, and retain the value indefinitely.



College Study Habits



Subject

- College Students' study habits

Opinion

- Ways to improve

Main Points

- Study in a quiet environment
- Pay attention in class
- Manage their time well



Thesis Statement



College students' study habits can be improved by several ways by studying in a quiet environment, paying attention in class and managing their time well.



Stress in Students



Subject

- Stress in students

Opinion

- Methods to handle

Main Points

- Eating more fruits
- Breathing deeply
- Sharing feelings with friends

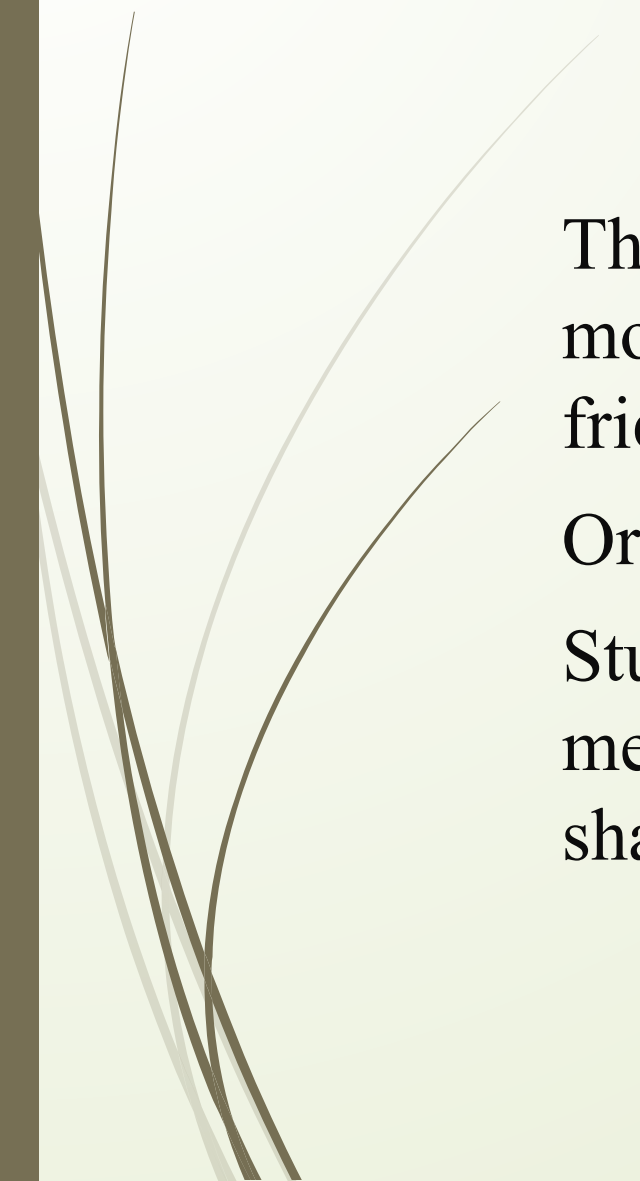


Thesis Statement

The three ways students can handle stress better are eating more fruit, breathing deeply and sharing their feelings with friends.

Or

Students can handle stress better by using three important methods that are eating more fruit, breathing deeply and sharing their feelings with friends.





Common Errors in Thesis Statement

1. Write statements, not announcements
 - ❑ I want to talk about the crime wave in our country
 - ❑ The recent crime wave in our city has several apparent causes
2. Avoid statements that are too broad
 - ❑ Men and women are very different
 - ❑ Men and women are often treated very differently in the work place
3. Avoid statements that are too narrow
 - ❑ The speed limit near my home is sixty-five miles per hour
 - ❑ The speed limit near my home should be lowered to fifty-five miles per hour for several reasons



Continued..

4. Make sure statements develop only one main idea
 - One of the most serious problems affecting young people today is bullying, and it is time more kids learned the value of helping others
 - One of the most serious problems affecting young people today is bullying

Activity

Identify the Topic and Controlling Idea

1. Our cafeteria would be greatly improved if several changes were made.
2. Celebrities are often poor role models because of the ways they dress, talk, and behave.
3. SUVs are inferior to cars because they are harder to control, more expensive, and dangerous to the environment.
4. Stress in the fast-food workplace has led to serious physical, psychological, and emotional problems for employees.
5. Living in the city has certain advantages over living in the suburbs.
6. Before moving away from home, every person should have mastered certain key skills.
7. Independent mom-and-pop stores are superior to larger chain stores for a number of reasons.

Activity on Page number 96-98



Write A beside each sentence that is an announcement rather than a thesis statement. Write OK beside the statement in each pair that is a clear, limited point that could be developed in an essay.

1. This essay will discuss the people you meet in exercise class.
2. The kinds of workout clothes worn in my aerobic class identify “jocks”, “strugglers”, and “princesses”.
3. I made several mistakes in the process of trying to win the respect and affection of my teenage stepson.
4. My thesis in this paper is relationships between stepparents and stepchildren.
5. Loneliness is the subject of this paper.
6. My concern here is to discuss near-death experiences reported by some patients.



**Write TN beside each statement that is too narrow to be developed in an essay.
Write OK beside the statement in each pair that is a clear, limited point.**

_____ a. I had squash, tomatoes, and corn in my garden last summer.

_____ b. Vegetable gardening can be a frustrating hobby.

_____ a. The main road into our town is lined with billboards.

_____ b. For several reasons, billboards should be abolished.

_____ a. My first job taught me that I had several bad work habits.

_____ b. Because I was late for work yesterday, I lost an hour's pay and was called in to see the boss.



**Write TB beside each statement that is too broad to be developed in an essay.
Write OK beside the statement in each pair that is a clear, limited point.**

_____ In many ways, sports are an important part of American life.

_____ Widespread gambling has changed professional football for the worse.

_____ Modern life makes people suspicious and unfriendly.

_____ A frightening experience in my neighborhood has caused me to be a much more cautious person in several ways.

_____ Toys ads on television teach children to be greedy, competitive, and snobbish.

_____ Advertising has bad effects on all of society.